

Taylor Johnson

Resume

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I design, optimize, scale, and execute diverse experimental and operational workflows from sample acquisition to data analysis to answer complex biological questions, with emphasis on rigorous documentation and clear communication of results.

Technical core competencies

- Molecular biology & genomics assay development
- Experiment and operational workflow design
- Cross-disciplinary collaborations
- Contextualized problem-solving

Employment History

Staff Research Associate at the University of California | San Francisco, CA.

2018 – present

SRA III – Lab Manager for [Dr. Jennifer Yokoyama](#) at the UCSF Fein Memory and Aging Center (MAC)

- Wet lab
 - Lead protocol and experimental design for genomic and molecular biology research studies from pilot to [global scales](#)
 - **Technological expertise:** NGS library preparation, droplet digital PCR, qPCR, flow cytometry, cryostat tissue sectioning, cell culture, clinical sample processing, nucleic acid and protein preparation/purification, QA/QC
 - Built and operationalized a neurogenetics lab supporting multi-project genomic studies, established sample acquisition pipelines (brain tissue, CSF, plasma), developed cross-lab collaborations and strategies supporting evolving priorities
 - Managerial and administrative lead: hiring, training, BUA authorship, logistical and operational lead, etc.
 - Contribute to manuscript authorship, data analysis, publication efforts and presentations
- Dry lab
 - Revived a retrospective cohort study leading to publication and adjunct [data sharing](#) effort
 - Analysis of datasets to support ongoing projects – single cell RNA sequencing analysis, proteomic datasets
 - Computational proficiencies: R, bash, GitHub
 - Design, development, and maintenance of the Yokoyama Lab biorepository database (FreezerWorks LIMS)

Research Associate at California Polytechnic State University | San Luis Obispo, CA.

2017 – 2018

Research Associate – Lab associate for Dr. Marie Yeung

- Probing Human Epithelial Cell Responses to Commercial Probiotic Bacterial Strains
 - Presented at the 2018 CSUPERB Biotechnology Research Symposium
- Enhancing Recoverability of Lyophilized Lactic Acid Bacteria
 - Presented at the 2017 College of Science and Mathematics Student Research Conference

Environmental & Field Research Experience

California Department of Public Health

2025 – Present

- [Phytoplankton Monitoring Program](#) volunteer. Conduct biweekly monitoring of domoic acid-producing phytoplankton at the Pacifica Municipal Pier, contributing to a [statewide longitudinal dataset](#) used to track seasonal and interannual harmful algal bloom dynamics, inform public health updates along the California coast, and assess climate-driven ecological change.

Education

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

2015 – 2018

- Bachelor of Science in Wine and Viticulture; concentration: Enology (GPA 3.65; Honors: Cum Laude)
- Minor: Microbiology
- Recipient of faculty awarded, Academic Scholar Grant (2018)

Santa Barbara City College

2011 – 2014

- Associate of the Arts in Science and Math (GPA 3.52; graduation with Honors)

Selected publications & presentation

Johnson, Taylor P., and Jennifer S. Yokoyama. “[Dried Plasma Spot Biomarker Test for Alzheimer’s Disease Population Screening Using qPCR Systems](#).” Taudia, 10 Mar. 2026.

Elder, N., Nguyen, H., Wan, J., Johnson, T. P., Lee, M., Ng, C., Yokoyama, J. S., Lin, R. SPLASH: A Benchtop Platform for Accessible Ultrasensitive Quantification of Plasma Biomarkers in Alzheimer’s Disease. medRxiv (Preprint), 2026. doi.org/10.64898/2026.02.21.26346786

Johnson, Taylor P., et al. Reduced Levels of Angiogenesis Biomarkers Predict Increased Symptom Severity in Chinese Americans with Alzheimer’s Disease with Demographic-Specific Effect, 9 Feb. 2025, doi.org/10.1080/13554794.2025.2455759.